

How to Run the Project

Event & Parking Reservation System

Setup guide, required login credentials, and end-to-end verification steps.

Quick start: Open the ASP.NET Core project in Visual Studio 2022, apply the EF Core database migration, run the HTTPS profile, and sign in with the seeded admin account.

1. Requirements

Requirement	Purpose
Visual Studio 2022	Install the ASP.NET and web development workload.
.NET 8 SDK	The project targets .NET 8.
SQL Server LocalDB / SQL Server Express	Required for the Eventparkingdb database.
SQL Server Management Studio (SSMS)	Recommended for checking tables and data.
Internet connection	Useful only when restoring NuGet packages for the first time.

2. Required Login Credentials

The project automatically creates the administrator account on a fresh database through **AdminSeeder**. Use the following credentials for the Admin module:

Role	Administrator
Email	admin@parkora.com
Password	Admin@123
Access	Admin dashboard and admin modules

Customer login: Create a customer account from the website using the Create account tab, then sign in with those details. Customer passwords are not hard-coded in this guide.

Security note: Admin@123 is a demo credential for the student project. Change it before any real deployment.

3. Step-by-Step: Run the Project

Step 1 - Copy or clone the project

Copy the full EventParkingSystem project folder to the PC. Keep the Backend/EventParkingSystemApi folder structure unchanged.

Step 2 - Open in Visual Studio 2022

Open the solution/project that contains EventParkingSystemApi. Wait for Visual Studio to finish loading and restoring packages.

Step 3 - Check the database connection

Open appsettings.json and confirm DefaultConnection points to the SQL Server instance available on the PC. For LocalDB, the project uses the connection shown below.

```
Server=(localdb)\MSSQLLocalDB;Database=Eventparkingdb;Trusted_Connection=True;TrustServerCertificate=True;
```

Step 4 - Apply the database migration

In Visual Studio, open Tools > NuGet Package Manager > Package Manager Console and run:

```
Update-Database
```

Step 5 - Start the application

Select the HTTPS launch profile in Visual Studio and click Run (or press Ctrl+F5). The frontend is served from wwwroot and should open directly in the browser.

Step 6 - If the browser does not open automatically

Open the HTTPS URL shown by Visual Studio. A typical development URL is https://localhost:7194, but the port can differ from one PC to another.

Step 7 - Sign in as Administrator

Choose Sign in and enter admin@parkora.com / Admin@123. After successful login, the role should display as Admin and the Admin module should be available.

Step 8 - Test a customer account

Log out, create a normal customer account, sign in, and verify Discover, My Bookings, Feedback, Notifications, and Profile behavior.

4. Recommended Functional Test

#	Check	Expected result
1	Discover	Open an available event.
2	Seat selection	Select one or more available seats. Booked seats should stay visible but disabled.
3	Parking	Optionally select one available

		parking slot.
4	Booking	Confirm the booking and verify the booking number.
5	Payment	Complete the simulated payment. The booking should become Confirmed/Paid.
6	Feedback	Submit feedback only after payment. Submitted feedback should appear in the customer Feedback page and in the Admin feedback module.
7	Admin	Sign in as Admin and verify events, customers, dashboard totals, and all feedback.

5. Common Problems and Fixes

Problem	Fix
500 - Could not load events	Usually a database setup/connection issue. Run Update-Database, confirm Eventparkingdb exists, and check the Visual Studio Output window for the SQL exception.
401 / Session expired	Log out and sign in again. If login itself fails, verify the email/password and check that the account is active.
403 - Forbidden	The logged-in account does not have the required role. Admin-only endpoints require Role = Admin.
409 - Booking conflict	A selected seat/parking slot may already be allocated, a payment may already exist, or feedback may already have been submitted. Refresh the page and use the server message to identify the conflict.
HTTPS certificate warning	For local development, trust the ASP.NET Core development certificate or use the Visual Studio HTTPS profile and accept the local development certificate prompt.

Frontend does not open	Confirm launchBrowser is true and launchUrl is empty in Properties/launchSettings.json. The project should serve wwwroot/index.html through UseDefaultFiles and UseStaticFiles.
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6. Final Setup Checklist

- ☐ Visual Studio 2022 opens the project without build errors.
- ☐ NuGet packages restore successfully.
- ☐ Update-Database completes successfully.
- ☐ Eventparkingdb is created and contains the project tables.
- ☐ The browser opens the Parkora home page.
- ☐ Admin login works with admin@parkora.com / Admin@123 on a fresh setup.
- ☐ Customer registration and login work.
- ☐ Events, seats, parking, booking, payment, feedback, notifications, and Admin dashboard load correctly.

Project ready. When the checklist above passes, the project is ready for demonstration on that PC.